iPhone and iPad Setup

TRAIN LOG 1.0.27 · Field Book for Railfans

TRAIN LOG runs on a field device as a Home Screen app that works trackside with no signal. Its log lives on that device. Updates come from the public field site. Move sightings to the Mac with **Save a copy** / AirDrop, then **Import File** on the Mac — the apps are not live-linked.

The field device has the full New Entry card, the Log, Log Stats, and Activity. Importing, Export tools beyond Save a copy, charts, Data Check, and Settings are on the Mac.

Set Up Once

Use Safari. Prefer the public install address below — no Mac certificate and no pairing code.

1. **Install:** open https://graphicsmike.github.io/trainlog-field/ in Safari → Share → **Add to Home Screen**. Open the icon until **Offline ready**.
2. **Updates:** on the field device use footer **Updates** → **Check for Updates** → **Get Update** (refreshes from that site). You can also use footer **This device** → **Get Update** or **Repair Install**. Do not delete the Home Screen icon.
3. **Sightings to the Mac:** on the field device tap **This device** → **Save a copy** (or AirDrop the file), then on the Mac use **Import** → **Import File**. The Mac and field logs stay independent until you import.
4. Optional check: Airplane Mode → open the icon. If TRAIN LOG starts, you're set trackside.

Do not delete the Home Screen icon to update. Use footer **Updates** or **This device** → **Repair Install** if Reload is stuck.

Offline Ready

The badge under the TRAIN LOG name tells you whether the field device can be used with no signal:

- **Offline ready** (green): everything is saved on the device.
- **Saving for offline…**: keep the app open on Wi-Fi until it finishes. If it's closed early, it carries on next time.
- **Not offline yet**: open it on Wi-Fi (cellular is fine for the public site) until the badge turns green.
- **Open from your Home Screen**: you're in Safari. Use the Home Screen icon; it keeps its own copy and its own log.
- **Can't work offline here**: use the address that starts with `https://`.

Tap the badge for details and **Check Again**.

Moving Sightings

1. On the field device, open the Home Screen icon and tap **This device** → **Save a copy** (JSON). AirDrop or otherwise send that file to the Mac.
2. On the Mac, use **Import** → **Import File**. Trains already in the Mac log are skipped; edited copies wait in Import Review and never replace the Mac's row.

- Each field install keeps its own log. Importing onto the Mac does not clear the field device.
- After a new TRAIN LOG release is published to the field site, open **Updates** (or This device) and tap **Get Update**. When the refresh finishes, use **Reload New Version** if offered.
- If Reload is stuck, or the Home Screen copy won't open after an update, use **Repair Install** on This device, or open the field site with `?repair=1`. Sightings stay on the device. Do not delete the Home Screen icon to update.

Read Units

On the field devices, **Read Units** reads locomotive numbers off a video. It is not in the Mac app. **Tracks** and **Storyboard** are the two ways to watch the clip.

- The **Railroad** on a train fills the mark on every unit of that train. A mark you type, or a known mark for a different railroad, stays. An empty mark, or one the reader didn't recognize, follows the railroad you pick.
- **Next train** parks this train and opens a blank one.
- Opening Read Units stops a recording that is still running and keeps the clip. It is on the entry card when you come back.

On the Phone

- **New Entry** has Submit at the top and again under the train card.
- **Log** filters by From and To dates. Tap a train card to see everything about it, then Edit or Delete.
- **Dashboard** opens on **Trackside**: tap **Day** or **Trip**, then pick which one. It shows the count, first and last times, the last train and how long ago it passed, directions, railroads, train types, and where you saw them. Activity is the other tab.
- The full charts, Compare, More Stats, and Data Check are on the Mac.

If Updates Won't Load

1. Confirm the field device can reach the public site in Safari: https://graphicsmike.github.io/trainlog-field/.
2. Open footer **Updates** → **Check for Updates**. If a newer TRAIN LOG is listed, tap **Get Update**.
3. If Reload is stuck after an update, use **This device** → **Repair Install**. Sightings stay on the device.
4. The Home Screen icon should still open from its offline copy even when the site is unreachable.

The same steps are in TRAIN LOG under How to Use → iPhone and iPad.